

Final - Minutes of General Meeting of the West End Civic Association

May 8, 2025

Attendance

- WECA officers: Margaret Magner, President; Ajay Khetarpal, VP; Darlene Pierro, Treasurer; Duane Rollins, Corresponding Secretary
- WECA Block Captains: Maggie Hadley, Jane Pontius, Andrew Sellman, Brian Shipley, Rose Slater, Patricia Woodward
- Other Participants: Kathleen Amos, Becky Batt, Karen Buglass, Ralph Buglass, Kate Cohen, Amanda Collins, Kelly Ebner, Debra England, Don Hadley, Terrell Hale, Dan Hursinger, Kitty Hursinger, Jack Kelly, Thomas Kim, Zachary Levine, Bridget Donnell Newton, Donna Polhamus, Carolyn Pollard, Jacalyn Queen, Kim Queen, Maria Rescigna, Rachel Shuster, Jeff Spieler, Paul N. Um, Mike Weichbrod, Deborah Yurow

Call to Order

Former President Brian Shipley called the meeting to order at 7:05 pm. Brian chaired the meeting for Margaret Magner, who was on vacation (present via Zoom).

Election of 2025 – 26 WECA Officers

Brian explained the WECA officer nomination and election process and announced the following slate of candidates standing for election. This slate had been approved unanimously by motion of the Executive Board at the April 2025 meeting:

- For President - Ajay Khetarpal
- For VP - Darlene Pierro
- For VP of Outreach - Heidi Liu
- For Treasurer - Louise Lovell
- For Corresponding Secretary- Duane Rollins
- For Recording Secretary - Kelly Kalepe

The officers on the slate who were present introduced themselves and summarized their backgrounds. A motion was made and seconded to proceed to vote on the slate. There were no other nominations from the floor. The slate was voted in by those present with a show of hands (and vote via Zoom chat for those online). There were no objections or abstentions. The 2025–26 WECA officers are those stated above.

News and Information

- **Guest Speaker: Ralph Buglass, Local Historian and Author**

Rockville's Top Ten Claims to Fame: Our Hometown's Remarkable Historical Distinctions

Ralph Buglass then made a presentation about ten of Rockville's significant historical distinctions and connections to national events (slide deck for the talk is accessible [here](#)).

Update on Sale of Rockville Presbyterian Church (RPC) Education Building

Ajay Khetarpal read a statement provided to WECA by the RPC Trustees as an update on the sale with key points:

- The Church presented the top four bids to the congregation, which unanimously voted to approve a ranked ordering of those proposals. The Church is now moving forward with the steps to complete the sale to the top-ranked bidder approved by the Trustees and the congregation.
- The point was made that the building has been for years the home of the Rainbow Shelter and the RPCNS Nursery School. As details about the identity of the buyer and their intended future use of the building were not part of the report, Brian Shipley suggested waiting for further updates from the Church before trying to surmise the impact on the community.

Business Items

- **Upcoming Events**

Ajay Khetarpal gave the report. SpringFest will take place on May 17 from 12 to 3 pm at Lower Monument Park, with burgers, hot dogs, meatless options, kids' games and water provided. There will also be a snow cone vendor/truck. Attendees are encouraged to come enjoy the day and bring a side dish. There are several ways that residents can make a contribution to support the event.

- **Treasurer's Report**

Treasurer Darlene Pierro gave the report on finances in the month of April. WECA started April with \$3,946 in our checking account at Bank of America. We had income of \$1,250 from three payments from newsletter advertisers. We had expenses of \$1,838 from: the \$26.50 monthly fee for MailChimp, \$216 as the annual fee for our new website hosting service, and \$270 for the

new lawn signs about WECA monthly meetings and \$1,325 for the printing of our spring newsletter. We ended the month with a balance of \$3,358.
Darlene invited all to share cake after the meeting to toast the officers whose tenure is ending.

- **Public Safety Report**

Lt. Matney could not attend this meeting. He will report at the next WECA neighborhood meeting.

Open Forum

- A resident presented information about the Woodley Gardens pool “Information Session” on May 18 from 7:30-8:30 pm at the Rockville Senior Center Azalea Room. WECA will also send this information out in a community email.
- A question was raised about the maintenance of roads in the Falls Road area.

Adjournment

The meeting was adjourned at 8 pm.